Borderless MVP Definition

Phase I: Prove the Network

Based on the Strategy Paper, Product Requirements Document, and Operating & Business Blueprint, August 2026.

Product Definition

Borderless is an integrated cross-border trade platform. Its long-term role is to connect the fragmented layers around a trade transaction:

```text
Discover -> Verify -> Match & Negotiate -> Transact -> Finance -> Prepare -> Move -> Settle -> Learn
```

Phase I is a **managed marketplace focused on Market Access + Trust**. It is not a passive catalogue and it is not yet a complete transaction, logistics, finance, or intelligence platform. Human intervention is deliberately part of the MVP so Borderless can learn the workflow before automating it.

MVP Objective

Prove that Borderless can build a trusted network of businesses and consistently create qualified trade opportunities between buyers and suppliers.

The first success condition is that businesses join because they can find trusted trading partners.

Initial Market and Users

- Agriculture and agricultural trade participants.

- Narrow product categories and trade corridors.

- Buyers/importers, suppliers/exporters, manufacturers, processors, commodity traders, sourcing staff, verification staff, and administrators.

Phase I Capabilities

1. Verified Business Profiles

- Register a business, select a role, and add markets, categories, and company information.

- Submit verification information and display verification status.

- Support manual review, approval, rejection, and request-for-information states.

2. Discovery and Product Listings

- Search products, companies, and RFQs.

- Filter by country, category, role, and verification status.

- Publish structured agricultural listings with origin, specifications, availability, quantity, images, and supporting information.

- Edit, pause, archive, and moderate listings.

3. RFQs and Responses

- Create RFQs with product, quantity, origin/destination, timing, specifications, and commercial requirements.

- Target selected or relevant suppliers.

- Submit, review, and compare supplier responses and terms.

- Track RFQ status and keep communication connected to the request.

4. Managed Sourcing

Receive a requirement, search the network, identify and qualify counterparties, verify businesses, present options, introduce parties, support RFQs/quotations, and record the opportunity outcome.

5. Opportunities and Messaging

The opportunity record connects buyer, supplier, product, RFQ, messages, Borderless interventions, current status, next action, and outcome.

```text
```

New -> Sourcing -> Matched -> Verified -> Introduced -> RFQ -> Negotiation -> Qualified

```

Phase I supports buyer-supplier conversations, operational notes, unread notifications, and secure attachments when storage is available.

### *6. Admin and Analytics*

- Manage users and profiles.

- Review verification submissions.

- Moderate products and RFQs.

- Assign sourcing tasks and manage opportunities.

- Review suspicious activity.

- Measure registration, verification, listing, search, RFQ, response, introduction, negotiation, qualification, and repeat activity events.

## Buyer Experience

```text

Register -> Profile -> Verify -> Discover suppliers/products -> Review trust

-> Create RFQ -> Receive responses -> Message -> Compare -> Qualify opportunity

```

Exporter Experience

```text

Register -> Profile -> Verify -> Publish products -> Discover buyer demand

-> Respond to RFQ -> Message -> Qualify opportunity

```

The journeys converge around a shared opportunity record. Phase I ends at trusted discovery, matching, early negotiation, and qualification.
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Explicitly Out of Phase I

- Full transaction execution, purchase orders, and contracts.
- Escrow or protected payment.
- Integrated freight, customs, warehousing, insurance, and shipment tracking.
- Trade finance, FX, and insurance products.
- Advanced intelligence, forecasting, risk scoring, benchmarking, and AI sourcing.
- Multi-sector expansion before agricultural liquidity is proven.

Success Metrics

- Verified businesses, active buyers, and active suppliers.
- Qualified opportunities, RFQs, and RFQ response rate.
- Accepted introductions, negotiations started, repeat users, and time to qualified match.

Roadmap

- **Phase 0:** Manually facilitate real transactions and learn the workflow.
- **Phase I:** Market Access + Trust.
- **Phase II:** Quotes, purchase orders, contracts, documents, milestones, and payment coordination.
- **Phase III:** Freight, customs, transport, warehousing, insurance, and tracking.
- **Phase IV:** Purchase-order finance, invoice finance, working capital, FX, and insurance partners.
- **Phase V:** Pricing, market intelligence, risk, AI sourcing, forecasting, and analytics.

Operating Principles

- Create liquidity before creating complexity.
- Trust before scale.
- Start with the transaction.
- Own the customer relationship and workflow; integrate ecosystem infrastructure.

- Build with the ecosystem, not against it.

- Revenue should follow valuable or completed trade activity.